

Elusive truce: On the U.S. and the Russia-Ukraine war

Russia must **give up** its **maximalist** position and end the war

The Trump administration's **frustration** over the lack of progress in diplomatic efforts to end the Ukraine war **was evident** in Secretary of State Marco Rubio's **remarks** in Paris last week. After talks with America's European **allies**, he warned that the U.S. would "move away" if there was no progress "within days". U.S. President Donald Trump appeared to **endorse** the comments. Despite Mr. Trump's campaign promise to end the war "within 24 hours", months into his presidency, he remains far from building a **consensus** on even a temporary **ceasefire**. If he expected the Russians to jump on a proposal for a ceasefire in return for some Ukrainian **concessions**, he has **miscalculated**. The U.S. has already **ruled out** NATO membership for Ukraine and declared it would not be part of any post-war security guarantees for Kyiv prior to direct negotiations with Russia. It also **arm-twisted** Ukraine into proposing a 30-day ceasefire. However, while Mr. Trump appears focused on an immediate **cessation** of **hostilities**, the Kremlin has **insisted** that any ceasefire deal must be part of a **comprehensive** peace agreement that **addresses** its core security concerns. The U.S. is **reportedly** circulating a new proposal to end the fighting — shared with European and Ukrainian officials, it has the U.S. prepared to recognise Crimea, which Russia **annexed** in 2014 **following** a **contentious referendum**, as Russian territory. The plan also **takes** NATO membership "**off the table**" for Ukraine and **seeks** to **freeze** the conflict along the front line, effectively leaving the territories Russia captured since the war began in 2022 in its hands. After responses from Ukraine and Europe, the U.S. plans to approach Moscow. But Russia has **stuck to** its maximalist positions, which include rejecting security guarantees for Ukraine and insisting on its **demilitarisation**.

Wars rarely end through maximalist positions. While Russia has made **territorial** gains, it has also **paid a price**. **Ukraine**, despite its **apparent** weakness on the battlefield, **signals** that it is ready to continue the fight, with western support. Europe has also made it clear that it will continue **backing** Ukraine — with or without American involvement. For any **lasting** peace in Ukraine, it is important to address Russia's **legitimate** security concerns. However, the Russian demands that Ukraine **limit** its defence partnership with its allies or accept restrictions on its military capabilities are **untenable** for any **sovereign** nation. So, Mr. Trump should continue to **strive for** common **ground** between all the parties — the U.S., Ukraine, Europe and Russia — for a **durable** peace, instead of **appeasing** just one power.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

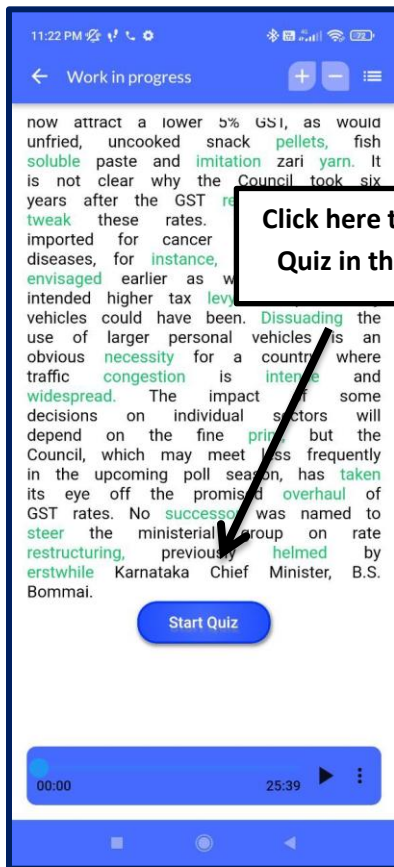
1. **Elusive** (adjective) – difficult to find, hard to achieve, evasive, intangible, slippery
पकड़ में न आने वाला
2. **Truce** (noun) – ceasefire, armistice, peace agreement, suspension of hostilities, pause
युद्धविराम
3. **Give up** (phrasal verb) – surrender, abandon, relinquish, renounce, forgo छोड़ देना
4. **Maximalist** (adjective) – of or denoting an extreme opinion. अपनी सर्वोच्च माँग पर डटा रहनेवाला व्यक्ति
5. **Evident** (adjective) – obvious, clear, apparent, noticeable, manifest स्पष्ट
6. **Remark** (noun) – comment, statement, observation, note, declaration टिप्पणी
7. **Ally** (noun) – partner, associate, supporter, friend, collaborator सहयोगी / मित्र राष्ट्र
8. **Endorse** (verb) – support, approve, back, sanction, ratify समर्थन करना
9. **Consensus** (noun) – agreement, unity, harmony, concord, common view आम सहमति
10. **Ceasefire** (noun) – truce, suspension of fighting, halt, stoppage, armistice
संघर्षविराम
11. **Concession** (noun) – compromise, allowance, adjustment, yielding, grant
रियायत
12. **Miscalculated** (adjective) – mistaken, misjudged, incorrect, flawed, erroneous
ग़लत आकलन किया गया
13. **Rule out** (phrasal verb) – exclude, eliminate, dismiss, reject, deny अस्वीकार करना / नकारना
14. **Arm-twist** (verb) – coerce, pressure, compel, force, manipulate दबाव डालना
15. **Cessation** (noun) – halt, stop, termination, end, discontinuation समाप्ति
16. **Hostility** (noun) – conflict, animosity, aggression, enmity, opposition शत्रुता / विरोध
17. **Insist** (verb) – demand, emphasize, assert, urge, maintain ज़ोर देना
18. **Address** (verb) – deal with, tackle, handle, respond to, resolve समाधान करना / ध्यान देना
19. **Reportedly** (adverb) – allegedly, supposedly, according to reports, said to be, claimed रिपोर्ट के अनुसार
20. **Annex** (verb) – seize, occupy, take over, appropriate, capture अधिग्रहण करना / कब्ज़ा करना

21. **Following** (preposition) – after, subsequent to, ensuing, in the wake of, as a result of के बाद
22. **Contentious** (adjective) – controversial, disputed, debatable, provocative, polemical विवादास्पद
23. **Referendum** (noun) – public vote, plebiscite, ballot, poll, popular vote जनमत संग्रह
24. **Take (something) off the table** (phrase) – withdraw, remove from discussion, exclude, retract, eliminate चर्चा से हटाना
25. **Seek** (verb) – try, aim, pursue, look for, endeavor प्रयास करना / खोज करना
26. **Freeze** (verb) – halt, stop, immobilize, suspend, block स्थिर कर देना
27. **Stick (to)** (verb) – adhere, remain with, hold to, follow, maintain टिके रहना / पालन करना
28. **Demilitarisation** (noun) – disarmament, demobilization, neutralization, non-militarization, pacification निरसैनिकरण
29. **Territorial** (adjective) – geographic, land-related, regional, spatial, bordering क्षेत्रीय
30. **Pay a price** (phrase) – suffer consequences, bear the cost, endure loss, incur penalty, face the fallout कीमत चुकाना
31. **Apparent** (adjective) – obvious, visible, evident, noticeable, seeming स्पष्ट / प्रतीत होता
32. **Backing** (noun) – support, aid, assistance, endorsement, sponsorship समर्थन
33. **Lasting** (adjective) – enduring, permanent, long-term, sustained, stable स्थायी
34. **Legitimate** (adjective) – lawful, valid, rightful, justifiable, authorized वैध / उचित
35. **Limit** (verb) – restrict, confine, reduce, cap, restrain सीमित करना
36. **Untenable** (adjective) – indefensible, unsustainable, unacceptable, unjustifiable, illogical असंभव / अस्वीकार्य
37. **Sovereign** (adjective) – independent, autonomous, self-governing, free, supreme संप्रभु
38. **Strive** (for) (verb) – attempt, endeavor, struggle, aim, work hard प्रयास करना
39. **Ground** (noun) – basis, foundation, reason, justification, principle आधार
40. **Durable** (adjective) – long-lasting, strong, stable, enduring, tough टिकाऊ
41. **Appease** (verb) – pacify, placate, satisfy, calm, mollify तुष्ट करना / शांत करना

Summary of the Editorial

1. U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio recently expressed impatience over the lack of diplomatic progress in ending the Ukraine war.
2. President Trump backed Rubio's warning that the U.S. might "move away" if no progress is made "within days."
3. Despite Trump's campaign promise to end the war in 24 hours, his administration has struggled to build support even for a temporary ceasefire.
4. The U.S. tried to broker a 30-day ceasefire by pressuring Ukraine, but it failed to sway Russia.
5. Russia insists that any ceasefire must be tied to a comprehensive peace deal addressing its core security demands.
6. The U.S. has reportedly circulated a new proposal that includes recognizing Russia's annexation of Crimea.
7. The plan also removes the possibility of Ukraine joining NATO and seeks to freeze the conflict along current front lines.
8. This proposal, if accepted, would effectively leave Russian-occupied territories from the 2022 invasion in Moscow's control.
9. After consulting with Ukraine and European allies, the U.S. plans to approach Russia with the proposal.
10. Russia, however, continues to hold firm on its maximalist demands, including Ukraine's demilitarisation and exclusion from Western alliances.
11. The editorial argues that wars rarely conclude successfully with maximalist positions, especially when both sides have suffered costs.
12. Ukraine shows willingness to continue the war with backing from the West, despite being militarily weaker.
13. European nations have committed to supporting Ukraine, even if the U.S. pulls back.
14. Any lasting peace must consider Russia's genuine security concerns, but not at the cost of Ukraine's sovereignty.
15. The editorial urges Trump to seek balanced diplomacy involving all stakeholders — not just to appease Russia — for a durable resolution.

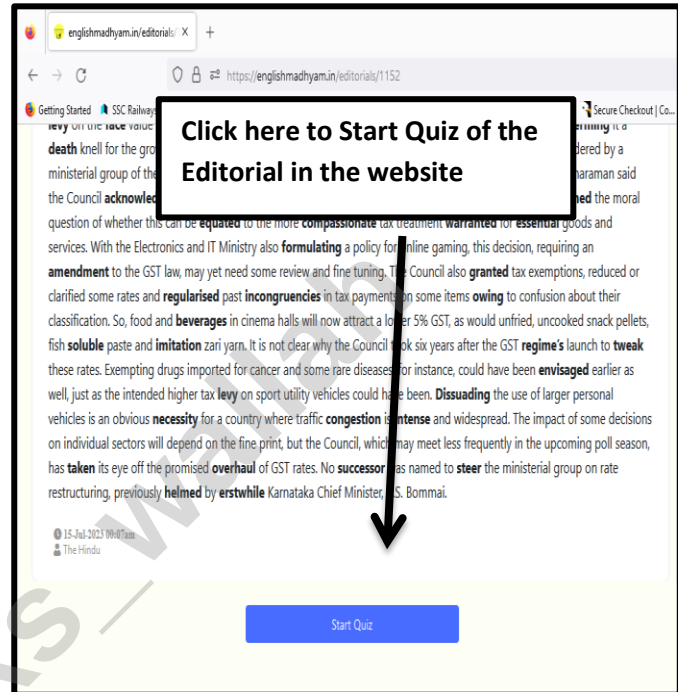
Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



Click here to Start
Quiz in the App

Start Quiz

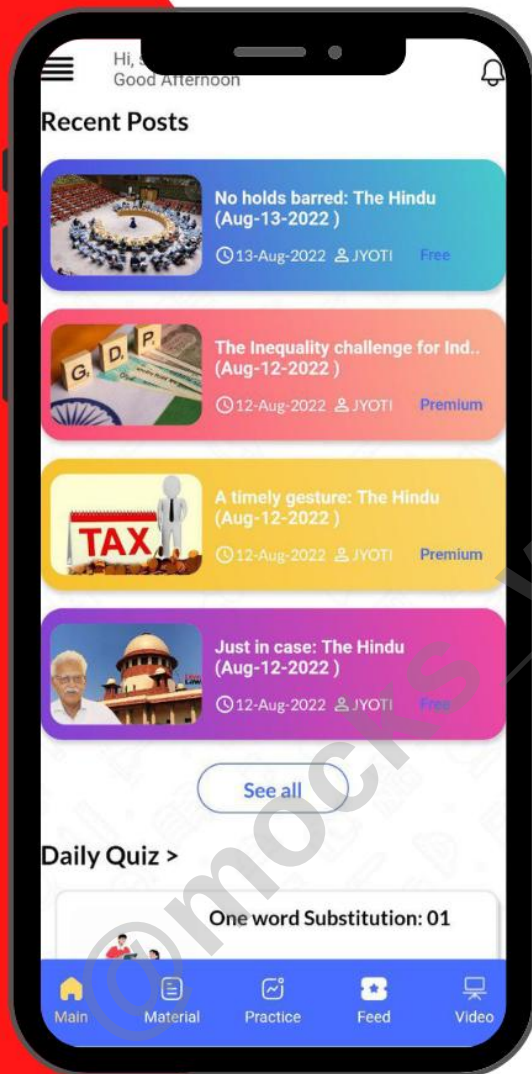
[Click here to download App](#)



Click here to Start Quiz of the
Editorial in the website

Start Quiz

[Click here to visit website](#)



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam